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Subject : - Cloud computing.
Class roll no : - 206
Session : - 2024-27

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Q.1. What are the innovative characteristics of cloud computing?

Cloud computing is fundamentally innovative just because it's "remote servers," but because it represents a complete paradigm shift in how we acquire, manage, and think about IT resources.

(i) On-Demand Self-Service

(The "Consumerization" of IT)

- Innovation :- A user (developer, business analyst) can provision computing resources like servers, storage, or databases instantly and automatically, without any human interaction with the provider.

- Impact :- It breaks the traditional IT procurement cycle (raising tickets, getting approvals, waiting for hardware). This dramatically accelerates innovation and experimentation, enabling agile development and DevOps practices.

(ii) Broad Network Access (Universal Connectivity)

- Innovation: - Capabilities are available over the network and accessed through standard mechanisms (web browsers, APIs, mobile apps) by a diverse set of clients (Phones, Laptops, IoT sensors).
- Impact: - It enables truly location-independent computing. Applications and data are accessible from anywhere, powering remote work, global collaboration, and the Internet of Things (IoT). The "edge" of the network becomes an extension of the cloud.

(iii) Resource Pooling (The Multi-Tenant Engine)

- Innovation:- The provider's computing resources are pooled to serve multiple customers using a multi-tenant model. Physical and virtual resources are dynamically assigned and reassigned according to consumer demand.

You don't know where your "server" is physically located (country, data centre, rack), but you can specify high-level constraints (e.g., region).

- Impact:- This enables massive economies of scale and efficiency that no single company could achieve on its own. It's the foundation for low costs and high utilization rates.

(iv) Rapid Elasticity (The "Infinite" Scale Illusion)

- Innovation:- Resources can be elastically provisioned and released, sometimes automatically, to scale rapidly outward and inward commensurate with demand. To the user, the available resources appear to be infinite.
- Impact:- This solves the age-old problem of over-provisioning (buying expensive hardware for peak traffic that sits idle 90% of the time) and under-provisioning (crashing during traffic spike). It makes handling unpredictable growth or viral events feasible for startups and enterprise alike.

(V) Measured Service (Pay-Per-Use Utility Model)

- Innovation:- Resources usage is metered, monitored, and reported transparently for both the provider and the consumer. You pay for what you consume, like electricity or water.
- Impact:- The transform It from a Capital expenditure (CapEx) model (large upfront hardware costs) to an operational expenditure (OpEx) model. It enables fine-grained cost management, eliminates waste, and allows businesses to start small and scale costs linearly with growth.

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Q2. Which are the technologies on which cloud computing relies?

Cloud computing is a complex ecosystem built on a stack of foundational technologies that work together to deliver its innovative characteristics. Here's a breakdown of the key technologies, from the physical layer up to the management layer.

1. Virtualization & Containerization (The Abstraction Engine)

• Hypervisors (Type 1 & 2):

Software (like VMware ESXi, KVM, Microsoft Hyper-V) that creates and runs Virtual Machines (VMs). The abstract Physical hardware (CPU, memory, storage) and allow multiple "guest" operating system to run on a single physical "host" machine.

• Containers:

A lighter-weight alternative to VMs (Docker, containerd). They abstract at the operating system level, allowing applications and their dependencies to run in isolated user space, sharing the host OS kernel. This enables higher density and faster startup times.

- Orchestration:

Kubernetes has become the de facto standard for automating the deployment, scaling, and management of containerized application across clusters of hosts.

2. Networking & Connectivity (The circulatory system)

- Software-Defined Networking (SDN):

Decouples the network control plane (which decides how traffic flows) from the data plane (which forwards the traffic). This allows networking configuration to be programmatically managed via software (e.g., VMware NSX, Cisco ACI, cloud-native VPCs), enabling agile, on demand network creation.

- Load Balancers:

Distribute incoming application traffic across multiple targets (VMs, containers) to ensure high availability and fault tolerance.

- Content Delivery Networks (CDNs):

Geographically distributed networks of proxy servers that cache content close to users (e.g., CloudFront, Cloudflare Akamai).

- Virtual Private clouds (VPCs):

Logically isolated section of the cloud where you can launch resources in a virtual network you define, providing security and control.

3. Storage Technologies (The Persistent Foundation)

- Distributed File Systems:

Designed to store very large files across multiple machines (e.g., Google file system) (GFS), Hadoop HDFS, Amazon S3's underlying architecture).

- Object storage:

Manage data as objects (with metadata and a unique ID) rather than in a file hierarchy or blocks. It's highly scalable and durable for unstructured data (e.g., Amazon S3, Azure Blob storage, Google cloud storage).

- Block storage:

Provides raw storage volumes to VMs, akin to a physical hard drive (e.g., Amazon EBS, Azure Disk storage).

- Software-Defined storage (SDS):

Abstract storage hardware to allow policy-based provisioning and management of data storage, independent of the underlying hardware.

4. Management, Automation & DevOps Tools (The Brain & Nervous System)

- Infrastructure as Code (IaC):

Tools like Terraform, AWS CloudFormation, and Azure Resource Manager (ARM) templates allow you to define and provision cloud infrastructure using declarative configuration files.

- Configuration Management:

Tools like Ansible, Puppet and Chef automate the configuration and management of software on provisioned servers.

- Monitoring & Observability:

Prometheus, Grafana, AWS CloudWatch, Azure Monitor collect metrics, logs, and traces to provide visibility into the health and performance of cloud resources and applications.

- API-Driven Everything:

Every cloud action (sign up a server, create a database, scale a cluster) is performed via a RESTful API.

This is the programmatic interface that enables automation and integration with other tools.

S. Security & Identity (The Immune System)

- Cryptography:

Pervasive use of encryption for data at rest (in storage) and in transit (over the network) using standards like TLS and AES.

- Identity and Access Management (IAM):

Framework of policies and technologies (like OAuth, SAML, OpenID Connect) that ensure the right entities to the right resources. Examples: AWS IAM, Azure Active Directory.

- Hardware Security Modules (HSMs):

Physical or cloud-based appliances e.g., AWS Cloud-based dedicated HSM) that provides secure generation and storage of cryptographic keys.

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Q.3 Define cloud computing and identify its core features?

Cloud computing is the on-demand delivery of computing service - including servers, storage, databases, networking, software, analytics, and intelligence - over the internet ("the cloud") with a pay-as-you-go pricing model. Instead of owning and maintaining physical data centers and servers, organizations can access technology service on an as-needed basis from a cloud provider.

Core features of cloud computing

1. On-Demand Self-Service

Users can provision computing capabilities (Server time, network storage, software) automatically and instantly without requiring human interaction with the service provider.

Example:- Launching a virtual server in 60 seconds through a web portal.

2. Broad Network Access

Service are available over the network (internet) and accessed through standard mechanisms (web browser, mobile apps, APIs) by diverse client platform (laptops, smartphones, tablets).

Example:- Accessing your email, CRM, or documents from any device, anywhere.

3. Resource pooling :

The provider's computing resources are pooled using a multi-tenant model to serve multiple customers. Resources are dynamically assigned and reassigned according to demand.

Example: Company's data and another company's application may reside on shared physical servers, with resources optimized automatically.

4. Rapid Elasticity

Resources can be elastically provisioned and released - often automatically during a scale and removing them outward and inward with demand.

Example: - An e-commerce site automatically adding serves during a sale and removing them afterward.

5. Measured Service (Pay-Per-Use)

Cloud system automatically control, monitor, and report resource usage, enabling a pay-per-consumption billing model.

Example: - Receiving a detailed monthly bill showing exact costs of compute hours, storage used, and data transferred.

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Q.4 What are the major advantage of cloud computing?
The major advantage can be grouped into cost, Scalability, performance, and strategic benefits.

1. Cost Efficiency (Transforming Capital Expense to Operational Expense)

- No Upfront Capital Costs:

Eliminates the need to purchase and maintain expensive hardware, data centers, and utilities (Power, cooling, Physical Security).

- Pay-as-You-Go / Consumption-Based Model:

You only pay for computing resources, storage, and services you actually use. This shifts IT spending from a Capital Expenditure (CapEx) to an Operational Expenditure (OpEx).

- Reduced Operational Costs:

The cloud provider handles maintenance, upgrades, and security patching, reducing the need for large in-house IT teams.

2. Scalability and Elasticity (The Most Celebrated Advantage)

• Instant Scalability:

Resources (compute power, storage, bandwidth) can be increased or decreased with a few clicks or automatically. This is perfect for handling spikes in traffic (e.g., a retail website during Black Friday) or growing workloads.

• Global Reach in Minutes:

You can deploy application in data centers around the world to be closer to your users, improving latency, with minimal effort.

3. Performance and Reliability

• Massive Scale & Latest Hardware:

Top cloud providers run on a world-wide network of state-of-the-art, secure data centers, continuously upgraded with the latest generation of fast and efficient computing hardware.

• High Availability & Disaster Recovery:

Built-in redundancy, data replication, and geographic distribution make it easier and more cost-effective to ensure business continuity and disaster recovery than with on-premises setups.

4. Strategic and Operational Benefits

- Automatic Updates:

You benefit from automatic, seamless updates to the latest software and services without downtime or manual intervention.

- Collaboration & Remote Work:

Cloud services are inherently accessible from anywhere with an internet connection, enabling seamless collaboration and supporting modern remote and hybrid work models.

- Access to Advanced Technologies:

Cloud platforms provide easy, on-demand access to cutting-edge technologies like AI/ML, big data analytics, IoT platforms, and serverless computing, allowing businesses to experiment and innovate without massive investment.

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Q.5

Describe the vision introduced by cloud computing?
The vision introduced by cloud computing is far grander than simply renting servers online. It represents a paradigm shift in how society and businesses access, consume, and think about computing power and technology.

1. Computing as Public Utility

The most fundamental vision is that no one should have to build and maintain their own power plant to get electricity. Before the cloud, every company had to build its own "Power plant" - a data center. The cloud vision says: Just plug into the vast, shared grid of computing resources and pay only for what you use.

This democratizes access to immense computational power, making it available to a student, a startup, or a Fortune 500 company with equal ease.

2. Democratization of Innovation and Technology

- A lone developer in a garage has the same infrastructural capabilities as a large corporation.
- Advanced technologies like Artificial Intelligence, Big Data analytics, and global content delivery networks are accessible as services via an API, eliminating the need for PhDs or massive capital investment.
- Geography is irrelevant; innovation can happen anywhere, and services can be deployed globally in minutes.

3. The End of IT Constraints as a Limiting Factor

The traditional model was, "Our idea is limited by our budget for servers and our team's capacity to manage them." The cloud vision flips this. "If you can imagine it, you can build it." It shifts the constraint from infrastructure procurement to human creativity and problem-solving. The focus moves from managing boxes to writing code that delivers value.

4. The Agile, Experimentation - First Enterprise

The cloud enables a culture of rapid experimentation and iteration. The vision is:

- Fail fast, learn cheap:

Sign up an environment, test a hypothesis, and tear it down - all at minimal cost.

- Continuous Delivery & DevOps:

Software can be updated and improved multiple times a day, responding instantly to user feedback.

- Business Agility:

The entire IT infrastructure becomes elastic and programmable, allowing the business to pivot and adapt to market changes at unprecedented speed.

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Q.6

What does infrastructure-as-a-service refer to?
Infrastructure-as-a-service (IaaS) is a cloud computing model where a third-party provider delivers fundamental computing resources over the internet on a pay-as-you-go basis. Instead of purchasing and maintaining physical server, storage, and networking equipment, user rent these resources from a cloud provider.

Core Components of IaaS:

1. Virtualized Computing Resources
(Virtual Machines/Servers)
2. Storage (Block, File, or object storage)
3. Networking (Firewalls, load balancers, IP addresses, virtual networks)
4. Physical Data Centers
(The underlying hardware managed by the provider)

Common examples of IaaS Providers:

- Amazon web Services (AWS) EC2 & S3
- Microsoft Azure Virtual Machines & Blob storage
- Google Cloud Compute Engine & cloud storage
- IBM cloud
- Oracle cloud Infrastructure (OCI)

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Q.7 Give some example of public cloud?

Public clouds are massively scalable, on demand computing services offered by third-party provider over the internet

1. Amazon Web Services (AWS)

- The pioneer and market leader. Offers the broadest and deepest set of services.

Example: - EC2 (virtual servers), S3 (Object storage), RDS (databases), Lambda (Services computing)

2. Microsoft Azure

- Strong # 2, deeply integrated with Microsoft ecosystems.

Example: - Azure virtual Machines, Blob storage, Azure SQL Database, Active Directory integration

3. Google cloud Platform (GCP)

- Known for cutting-edge technology and data / AI strength.

Example: - Compute Engine, BigQuery (data warehouse), Google Kubernetes Engine (GKE), AI/ML tools (Tensorflow).

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Q.8. What is Google App Engine?

Google App Engine (GAE) is a platform-as-a Service (PaaS) offering from Google cloud platform. It's a fully managed, serverless platform from developing and hosting web application at scale.

It as a high-level "application container" where you simply deploy your code, and Google handles everything else servers, scaling, load balancing, patches, and infrastructure management.

Feature	App Engine Standard	App Engine Flexible
Runtime	Specific, sandboxed language runtime	Docked container (custom runtimes)
Startup Time	Near instant (milliseconds)	Slower (can be minutes) as it boots a container
Scaling	Scales to zero instantly	Minimum 1 instance always running unless scaled to zero
Local Environment	Can differ slightly from production	Container matches production locally.
Network access	Limited via URL Fetch.	Full network access, can SSH into instances
Pricing Model	More fine-grained, scales to zero.	Charges for underlying compute instance resources.
Use case	Web apps, APIs, mobile backends with rapid scaling needs.	Apps needing specific libraries, background processor.

Q.9

What is the most common scenario for a private cloud?

The most common scenario for a private cloud is a large, highly-regulated organization with specific security, compliance, or control requirements that cannot be met by public cloud. This is typically driven by mandates rather than technological preference.

Data Sovereignty & Regulatory Compliance
(The #1 Driver)

- Financial Services

Banks, insurance companies subject to regulations like GDPR, PCI-DSS, GLBA, or national banking laws that require data residency within country borders or strict audit controls.

- Government & Defence

Classified data, ITAR regulations, national security requirements that prohibit data on multi-tenant public infrastructure.

- Healthcare:

HIPAA compliance where some interpretations require physical control over infrastructure (through many now use public cloud with BAAs).

- Public Sector

Government agencies with policies mandating on-premises infrastructure for citizen data.

Q.10

What are the type of application that can benefit from cloud computing?

Cloud computing benefits a wide range of applications by providing on-demand resources, Scalability, flexibility, and cost efficiency.

Here are the main type of application that can benefit the most.

1. Web Applications

- Websites, e-commerce platforms, content portals
- Need to handle variable traffic and scale quickly
- Benefit from global distribution and high availability.

2. Mobile Application

- Apps requiring back-end servers, databases, or storage.
- Cloud enables fast push notifications, authentication, analytics, and API hosting

3. Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning

- Training ML models, running inference, GPU/TPU workloads
- Cloud provides massive compute power and managed AI services.

4. Big Data & Analytics

- Data warehousing, log analysis, real-time stream processing
- Cloud handles large datasets efficiently with distributed computing (e.g., BigQuery Redshift)

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Q.11

What are the most important advantages of cloud technologies for social networking application

1. Scalability (Handle Millions of Users Easily)

Social networks deal with unpredictable spikes viral posts, live streams, trending events. Cloud platforms automatically scale up (more server) or scale down as needed.

2. High Availability & Reliability

Cloud providers use globally distributed data centers,

- The app stay online even if one server of region fails.
- Faster access for user worldwide.
- Better user experience with low downtime

3. Cost Efficiency

Instead of buying expensive hardware, social networks pay only for the resources they use ("pay-as-you-go")

- Upfront infrastructure costs
- Maintenance and upgrade expenses

4. Fast Content Delivery (via CDN)

Social apps rely heavily on:

- Images
- Videos
- Stories
- Live streaming

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Q.12

List some of the challenges in cloud computing?

1. Security and Privacy Concerns

- Risk of data breaches
- Unauthorized access
- Compliance with data protection laws
- Data stored on third-party servers

2. Internet Dependency

Cloud services require a stable, high-speed internet connections.

Any network issue can interrupt access to resources.

3. Unexpected Costs

Although cloud can be cheaper, misuse or poor planning can lead to:

- Rapid cost increases
- Billing complexity
- Cost overruns due to auto-scaling

4. Vendor Lock-In

Switching from one cloud provider to another can be:

- Expensive
 - Time-consuming
 - Technically challenging
- This restricts flexibility.

Q.13

What are the main characteristics of platform-as-a-service solution?

The main characteristics of a Platform-as-a-Service (PaaS) solution.

1. Complete Development Environment

PaaS provides a ready-to-use environment for:

- Coding
- testing
- deploying
- managing applications

2. Managed Infrastructure

The provider manages:

- Servers
- Storage
- networking
- Operating System

3. Scalability and Elasticity

PaaS platforms automatically scale:

- Computer power
- Storage
- databases

4. Built-in Tools and Services

PaaS Solution include tool like:

- databases
- middleware
- API management
- authentication services
- CI/CD pipelines.

Q. 14 Provide some examples of IaaS implementation.
There are some common example of Infrastructure-as-a-Service (IaaS) implementation.

1. Amazon Web Services (AWS) EC2

- Virtual server (EC2 instances)
- Elastic storage (EBS, S3)
- Virtual networks (VPC)

2. Microsoft Azure - Virtual Machines

- Azure virtual Machines
- Azure storage
- Azure Virtual Network

3. Google Cloud Platform (GCP) - Compute Engine

- Virtual machines instances
- Persistent disk storage
- Virtual networking services

4. IBM Cloud Infrastructure

- IBM cloud virtual server
- Bare metal servers.
- Networking & storage services

5. Oracle Cloud Infrastructure (OCI)

- Compute instances
- Block and object storage
- Virtual cloud networks.

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Q.15

Give the name of some popular software-as-a Service solutions?

The most popular and widely used software-as-a Service (SaaS) Solutions across various categories:

Collaboration & Communication

- Microsoft 365 (formerly Office 365) Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, Teams, SharePoint.
- Google Workspace: Gmail, Google Docs, Sheets, Slides, Drive, Meet, Chat.
- Zoom: Video conferencing and webinars.

Customer Relationship Management (CRM)

- Salesforce: The market leader in CRM for Sales, and service hubs.
- Zoho CRM: Comprehensive CRM suite, part of the larger Zoho ecosystem.
- Freshworks: Suite including Freshsales (CRM), Freshdesk (Support), etc.

Marketing & Sales

- Mailchimp: Email marketing and automation (now a full marketing platform)
- Marketo (Adobe): Marketing automation and lead management.
- HubSpot Marketing Hub: Inbound marketing, SEO, and analytics.
- Salesforce Marketing Cloud: Digital marketing automation.
- LinkedIn Sales Navigator: Social selling tool.